

But here we are, in the mid-decade of the 2010s, and the sky's the limit. So why wait to grab your own star?

What kind of skills do you need to develop?

There's no one answer to that question. You and you alone know what your strengths and weaknesses are. Play to your strengths, and aim at negating your weaknesses. Go with what interests you, inherently. Keep in mind that school is where you were brute-forced your basic education. Move beyond that and remember that life is a learning experience. The global scenario is ever changing and like the universe, ever expanding to cover new avenues of education. If at any age you think you're 'way past your prime', well, one is never too old to stop learning new things. It's always a good time to step back and look at the road not taken and consider taking it.

Step One: Look into thyself

The first step would be to take some time to think about what you like doing. The only task worth throwing your heart and soul into is the kind of job that owns your heart and soul. So figuring out what gets to you is the first step towards figuring out what you need to learn. This is a fundamental flaw of a society that takes away that willingness to learn new things. Well, the old argument of 'what's the point of learning something that won't be a part of your future or your career' has been nullified. Want to learn cooking? There's always scope to be a chef. Always enjoyed trying out new delicacies, or reading that new best-seller, or even watching that blockbuster that released last week? Well, critics are in no short supply, but with the hundreds of opinions out there, we're sure you can find your fan following somewhere. At the end of the day, if nothing else works, you can follow the startup culture. Start your own little project. Work for yourself, independent of any professional name, brand or firm. Be your own person.

Step Two: Aptitude

The second step would be trying to figure out what skills you have the aptitude for. There are several organisations, both online and offline that do aptitude tests and performance tests professionally. Approach them and think about what the professionals think you'd be good at. But remember: advice is good advice when taken in moderation. Don't ignore it completely, but don't wear it on your sleeve, either. Ultimately, learning anything new is about you, more than what other people think is good for you.